My Friend Never Said Goodbye

By Robert Mauro

ANNIE: **(Pg 81-90)** *(Stands by weeds, then sits on bench)* I never thought anything like this could happen. Tommy, I thought you were my friend. Then you do this. *(Pause)* You didn't give anyone even a hint. You just... did it. *(She gets up and walks around.)* Maybe if we had had a fight. Maybe if something had been bothering you. *(She thinks.)* Maybe something was. You were moody - but so was I. *(She thinks.)* Maybe it was my fault. Maybe it was something I did? Tommy? *(She thinks; sit on bench.)* Maybe. But it's too late now. You're gone. And I'll never know. *(Looks up)* Thanks, Tommy. Thanks for not trusting me enough to confide in me. *(Pause)* Tommy, we used to talk. We used to do everything together. *(She tries to smile as she smells the flowers.)* Everything. *(She smiles and sighs.)* It was always Tommy and Annie, never Tommy or Annie. We came as a set. Tommy, what went wrong? Was it me? *(She pets the flowers.)* This is not fair. You shouldn't have done it! *(She is unable to speak.)* I'm sorry. But you really know how to hurt a guy. You know? You hurt me. We had so much. We had something special. *(She shakes her head.)* "Had" is right. It's all gone now, but the memories.

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INTRODUCTION

TOMMY: Many people at some time in their lives think about completing suicide. Most decide to live because they eventually come to realize that the crisis is temporary and death is permanent. On other hand, people having a crisis sometimes perceive their dilemma as inescapable and feel an utter loss of control. The result is death at his or her own hands. There are currently almost 32,000 suicides annually in the U.S. It is estimated that for every suicide there are 6 survivors. Based on this estimate, approximately 5 million American became survivors of suicide in the last 25 years. Annie is a survivor left to deal with the fact that "My Friend Never Said Goodbye" by Robert Mauro.

ANNIE: I should have known something was wrong when summer came and you didn't want to go to the lake, our lake, with me anymore. You always liked the lake. We'd spend hours and hours alone out there. . . together. *(She sits on bench.)* You really hurt me, you know. *(There is a long pause.)* So what can we do about it now? Huh? Tell me. Can you do that? Is that possible? *(She waits.)* I guess not. It's gone forever. Boys. Hey, I've been hurt by boys before. You weren't the first. *(She covers her mouth.)* But you hurt me the most. You never even said goodbye! *(She's almost in tears, then controls herself)* Not even a last hug. Tommy, this is not right. You can't just do things like that to people who love you. It's not fair. It's not. I wouldn't do that to you. I wouldn't do that to my dog. You shouldn't have done this. *(TOMMY enters and sits on the bench beside ANNIE.)*

TOMMY: I'm really sorry, Annie. *(She doesn't answer.)* Annie?

ANNIE: *(Totally ignoring TOMMY)* It was just not fair, do you hear me?

TOMMY: Annie, it wasn't you. Really.

ANNIE: I'll never know now if it was me. If I hurt you.

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TOMMY: Oh, no. Annie, you were the best thing that ever happened to me. You were. Annie?

ANNIE: You used to tell me everything, I thought.

TOMMY: I did tell you everything. At least at first.

ANNIE: *(She gets up and walks around, clutching her flowers.)* And I always told you everything. There were no secrets between us. None.

TOMMY: I know.

ANNIE: If I was mad, you knew it.

TOMMY: *(Smiles)* I know.

ANNIE: Maybe I was a grouch at times. . .

TOMMY: Hey. Never.

ANNIE: *(To herself)* Yes. I was. I know I was. And we'd argue and fight. *(She smells the flowers.)* But we always made up, Tommy.

TOMMY: We sure did. I'll always remember that. One of my good memories.

ANNIE: So why? Can you tell me?

TOMMY: *(Gets up and follows her around, but she doesn't ever look at him. He tries to catch her eye, but can't.)* I can tell you this much. . . Annie? Can you hear me? It wasn't you.

ANNIE: I know it was me. It was always me.

TOMMY: *(Trying to catch her eye)* No. No. It wasn't! I loved you! I always loved you! I'll always love you.

ANNIE: You probably just got tired of my grouchiness.

TOMMY: No. Never. Hey, I was a grouch at times, myself. Remember?

ANNIE: But you were no angel, Tommy.

TOMMY: *(Sits on bench)* Tell me about it.

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ANNIE: *(Covers her mouth for a second)* Oh, I'm sorry.

TOMMY: Hey. Stop apologizing. I'm not worth it.

ANNIE: See? Even now I hurt you. You never thought much about yourself, and when I called you names you must have really been hurt.

TOMMY: Yeah, I was - but I deserved it, Annie.

ANNIE: You'd always say, "But I deserved it, Annie." *(Pause as TOMMY nods)* I miss you, Tommy. Do you know that?

TOMMY: I do now. Yes, I do now.

ANNIE: No matter how much we fought or called each other names, I still miss you. And you didn't even say goodbye. People who love each other shouldn't do that.

TOMMY: I know.

ANNIE: You should have told me something was wrong. I'd never have left you. I loved you.

TOMMY: I was going to write a note, but. . . I couldn't think of what to say. What could I say? You know me? I was never much with words.

ANNIE: You were never good with words.

TOMMY: Hey, I could barely spell.

ANNIE: And your spelling. You spelled "Love" *(Spelling)* LoU-V.

TOMMY: She remembers.

ANNIE: How could I forget that? You were never good with words. You had other ways of showing me you loved me.

TOMMY: Now that is one thing I'll really miss.

ANNIE: Big macho man. You'd die if the guys knew how you used to pick me daisies at the lake and put them in my hair...

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TOMMY: Annie, don't... *(He's in real pain.)*

ANNIE: Who'd buy me silly cards and mail them to me for no reason. . .

TOMMY: Please don't, Annie. . .

ANNIE: For no reason, but because. . .

TOMMY: Don't.

ANNIE: Because you loved me.

TOMMY: *(It's as if he's been wounded.)* I loved you, Annie! I did. Annie, please don't be sad.

ANNIE: Everyone keeps saying, "Annie, please don't be sad." **TOMMY:** I'm not worth it, Annie.

ANNIE: "He's not worth it, Annie."

TOMMY: Annie... please... Annie.

ANNIE: Annie, Annie, Annie. What do they know? *(She sits beside him on the bench.)* What did anyone know? How can they possibly know how I feel? You broke my heart.

TOMMY: Annie, I didn't know.

ANNIE: Tommy...

TOMMY: Yes...

ANNIE: Why did you do this to me, Tommy? Can you tell me?

TOMMY: It had nothing to do with you! Can't you hear me?

ANNIE: I know it was me.

TOMMY: *(Screaming in pain)* NO! IT WAS NOT YOU!

ANNIE: Yes.

TOMMY: No, no. Can't you understand? It was not you, Annie. I love you.

ANNIE: He never really loved me.

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TOMMY: *(In real pain)* What?

ANNIE: If you loved me, you'd have told me.

TOMMY: I did love you! And it had nothing to do with you. Nothing!

ANNIE: Whatever it was, it had something to do with me.

TOMMY: No.

ANNIE: Yes. I guess we're all partially to blame... That's what everyone says.

TOMMY: No.

ANNIE: I know it's true. I'll never forgive myself.

TOMMY: It's not your fault, Annie.

ANNIE: Yes. It had something to do with me.

TOMMY: No, no, no . . .

ANNIE: It had everything to do with us

TOMMY: How can you say that?

ANNIE: - because we were friends. And friends help each other no matter what it is that is bothering them. That's what friends are for.

TOMMY: Annie, I'm sorry. I should have told you.

ANNIE: Tommy, no matter what it was, I would have understood. You should have told me.

TOMMY: Annie, I'll tell you now. Can you hear me? Annie? Are you listening to me?

ANNIE: We always listened to each other. Always.

TOMMY: Always.

ANNIE: But now it's too late.

TOMMY: No.

ANNIE: Yes. Too late. You're gone forever.

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TOMMY: Annie, I'm right here. Beside you. Right on this bench. Can't you see me?

ANNIE: I'll never see you again.

TOMMY: Annie, look! I'm right here!

ANNIE: If I could only feel your arms around me.

TOMMY: *(He hugs her, but she feels nothing.)* Annie, I love you!

ANNIE: *(She shivers.)* What was that icy chill?

TOMMY: Chill?

ANNIE: I must be getting a cold. *(She stands.)*

TOMMY: A chill? From me? I love you.

ANNIE: I'd tell you how much I loved you. But it's too late for that now. I'll never know why you did it, Tommy.

TOMMY: Annie, neither will I!

ANNIE: It was so sudden.

TOMMY: It was a dumb, stupid mistake. I was just so down over so many things. It seemed there was nothing left.

ANNIE: You could have gotten help. Everyone can.

TOMMY: I know that now.

ANNIE: It's too late now. I know you could have worked things out. Even this. Together we could have.

TOMMY: Yes.

ANNIE: I guess for as long as I live, I'll always blame myself for what happened.

TOMMY: Oh, no. Annie, I'll never be able to rest in peace if you think that. Annie, I love you.

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ANNIE: I'm sorry if I caused you any pain. And I'm sorry if I can't come to see you anymore. . .

TOMMY: What? No . . .

ANNIE: It's been a year now. A whole new summer is here. It's beautiful. I wish we could enjoy it together. I wish I could be with you, but my doctor says it's not healthy to dwell on the past. So, Tommy, I've come for the last time.. .

TOMMY: Oh, no . . . please, Annie, don't leave me.

ANNIE: I just had to come here one last time. . .

TOMMY: No...

ANNIE: I had to come just one more time just to say goodbye to you... my dear, sweet friend... Tommy. *(She stands.)*

TOMMY: Annie, no. Don't go. I love you! Don't go!

ANNIE: I have to go. Goodbye, Tommy. *(She exits.)*

TOMMY: Noooo... Annie, please don't leave me alone. Annie! (*Curtain falls as TOMMY puts his head in his hands.)*

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AWARD HISTORY

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